SPEAKER ONE-SHEET

SWABIR SHARIFF

Founder & Executive Director, The Good Guides · Leadership Advisor & Speaker

"I built The Good Guides to change the starting line for young people — not just cheer them on from it."



10,000+
YOUTH MENTORED

1 of 100
QECT 100 YOUNG LEADERS AWARDEE 2026 — SELECTED THROUGH A HIGHLY COMPETITIVE PROCESS FROM THOUSANDS OF APPLICATIONS ACROSS THE 56 COMMONWEALTH COUNTRIES

ABOUT

Born and raised in Scarborough's Toronto Community Housing, Swabir Shariff watched family and friends pulled toward the justice system while services meant to help never reached them — young people couldn't see themselves in them and disengaged. Years as a Director of Security in Scarborough, leading round-the-clock operations for a major retail centre, where conversations with young people who had stopped showing up to school showed him what was missing. He founded The Good Guides in 2020, while still serving as Director of Security, and later stepped away to lead it full time. Built with young people, not prescribed at them, it has mentored 10,000+ youth and helped direct over a million dollars in investment into The Good Guides and other Scarborough youth initiatives. It delivers school-based violence prevention programming with local community partners, funded by the City of Toronto's Youth Violence Prevention Grant (2023).

SIGNATURE TALKS

01 — Keys to the Whole House

Why young people don't need a seat at someone else's table — they need the keys: real authority over the work, with real support behind them. A working model for sharing decision-making with the people a program serves, and an honest account of the trust that follows.

02 — Change the Starting Line

The answer to youth violence — and to every system that leaves people behind — is redesigning where people start, not asking more effort from the people the start failed. A framework for finding the starting lines inside your own system, and the first moves to change them.

03 — Every Piece of the Whole

Each of us is a productive piece of a whole none of us can see in full. Leadership as the work of letting each piece land — every person in the room a working part of the result, nobody a guest and nobody a passenger.

Also available as a fireside conversation or panel · Virtual or in-person

SELECTED RECOGNITION

100 Young Leaders Awardee, 2026
The Queen Elizabeth II Commonwealth Trust (QECT) — 1 of 100, selected through a highly competitive process from thousands of applications across the 56 Commonwealth countries

Toronto Community Champion, 2025
City of Toronto award (Honourable Mention) — received by The Good Guides

Rising Star — Scarborough Walk of Fame
Inducted April 2024

Ambassador — One Young World
Featured in the Ambassador Spotlight, September 2026

Best Individual Contribution to Youth Engagement
CharityVillage, 2021

SELECTED ENGAGEMENTS

Selected engagements, 2023–2025: Toronto Police Service College · OPTrust · Scarborough Walk of Fame induction remarks · post-secondary panels · organizational events and private businesses · Toronto schools.

BOOKING

Now booking 2027

Toronto · Scarborough · On the ground since 2020
Based in Toronto; available across Canada and the Commonwealth.

Speaking and advisory engagements are contracted with Swabir Shariff personally, independent of The Good Guides. Personal advisory is not offered to current funders or delivery partners of The Good Guides.

ENQUIRE · LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/swabir · Enquiries also via his personal website